



**United
Nations**

Department of
Economic and
Social Affairs



Local E-Government Toolkit

Empowering Local Governments Through Digital Transformation

E-Government Literacy



5. E-Government Literacy Index

Indicator	Description
<u>1. #206 Internal search mechanism</u>	A search bar on the main web page of the municipal government portal.
<u>2. #225a Facilitation of free Internet access</u>	Information on connecting to the city's free WIFI or statements of agreement with mobile operators
<u>3. #225b Access to physical spaces</u>	Information on government access to physical spaces for online services
<u>4. #234 Privacy policy</u>	Existence of a privacy policy or statement available on the MGP
<u>5. #237 Open data metadata</u>	The provision of relevant metadata about each open data file.
<u>6. #240 Online user support</u>	A Help or 'Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)' feature available on the portal.
<u>7. #241 Information on online services use</u>	Guidance or tutorials to people in understanding and using online services.
<u>8. #245 Portal authentication</u>	Any kind of authentication required to access online services or restricted-access areas (e.g., digital ID; login and password; mobile key)
<u>9. #270a Live chat support with a person</u>	The provision of "live chat" support functionality with municipality employees/officers in real time.
<u>10. #273 Social networking features</u>	The provision of social networking feature(s) (e.g. Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Flickr, etc.).

1. Internal search mechanism (#206)

What	Qualified by a search bar on the main web page of the municipal government portal and verified through a search using one word.
Why	Enables visitors to quickly and efficiently find specific information, services, or resources, enhancing user experience, promoting accessibility, and increasing overall user satisfaction and engagement.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Choose a Search Engine: a. Select a reliable search engine service or software that fits your budget and technical requirements. Google Custom Search, Algolia, and Elasticsearch are popular options. 2. Index Website Content: a. Ensure pages, documents, and resources on the municipal website are indexed by the search engine. 3. Design User-Friendly Interface: a. Place the search bar prominently on the homepage and all other key pages. 4. Faceted Search (Filters): a. Implement filters that allow users to refine search results based on categories such as departments, document types, or publication dates. 5. Regularly Update Content: a. Keep the website content up-to-date. For more information check out Lynton's guide or Fresh Tech Tips.
Case Examples 	Check out Mexico City's search bar available on the main page.



2. Facilitation of free Internet access (#225a)



What	Evidence of government provision of free access to the Internet i.e. free WIFI in specific areas or agreement with mobile operators.
Why	Vital for promoting digital inclusion, bridging the digital divide, and ensuring equal access to essential online services and information for all residents.
How?	Indicative steps: Dedicated Webpage: - Create a user-friendly webpage detailing free Internet access locations and instructions. Clear Information: - Provide concise details on how to connect Promotion: - Actively promote the initiative through social media, events, and local businesses. Updates and Feedback: - Regularly update the webpage and provide a feedback mechanism for user suggestions and issues.
Case Examples	Check out Tokyo's Free Wi-Fi Webpage .





3. Access to physical spaces for online services (#225b)

What

Information on the Municipal government portal of government provision of physical spaces i.e. community centers, post offices, libraries and personal assistance to access online services in these locations.

Why

Crucial for ensuring inclusive and equitable access to government services, fostering digital literacy, and enhancing community engagement.

How?

Indicative steps:

1. Partnership:

- a. Collaborate with community centers, post offices, and libraries to integrate online services.

2. Infrastructure:

- a. Provide necessary technology and internet access at these locations.

3. Training:

- a. Train staff to assist residents in accessing online services effectively.

4. Awareness:

- a. Promote the availability of services through local campaigns and the municipal portal.

5. Feedback:

- a. Establish a feedback system for continuous improvement and resident satisfaction.

Case Examples



Check out [Helsinki's Digital Support](#) at service centres page.

Submit your case [here](#)

What	A formal statement, often found in the footer or home page either explicitly stated or in a related link, explains how the website collects, processes, stores, & protects the personal information of its users.
Why	Essential for establishing trust with users, ensuring compliance with relevant privacy laws and regulations, and demonstrating the government’s commitment to protecting individuals’ privacy
How?	Indicative Steps: 1. Clear Language: - Write the policy in simple, understandable language. - Specify what user information is collected & detail methods: cookies, forms, or third-party. 3. Processing & Storage: - Explain how collected data will be used. 4. Security Measures: - Describe data protection measures in place. 5. User Rights: - Outline user rights regarding their data and Include opt-out and data deletion options. 6. Legal Compliance: - Highlight adherence to data protection laws. Check out wikiHow’s on How to Create a Website Privacy Policy or The U.S. General Services Administration section on Privacy and identity management
Case Examples 	Check out New Delhi’s Privacy Policy page



5. Open data metadata (#237)

What	The provision of relevant metadata, such as description, date, author, and other relevant information about each open data file by the municipal government website.
Why	Enhances data transparency, facilitates accurate understanding and usage, and allows users to assess the data's relevance and reliability, promoting informed decision-making and fostering trust in the municipal government
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Standardize Metadata Fields: a. Establish a standardized format for metadata fields to maintain consistency across all datasets. 2. Detailed Descriptions: a. Encourage authors to provide in-depth descriptions of the dataset 3. Accurate Date and Versioning: a. Always include the date of dataset creation or the last update. 4. Author Information: a. Include the name, contact details, and affiliation of the individual or department for the dataset. 5. Relevant Tags and Categories: a. Assign appropriate tags and categories to each dataset. 6. Data Format and Size: a. Specify the file format (e.g., CSV, JSON, Excel) and size of the dataset. Check out Ireland's Open Data Portal Guide or Center for Gov
Case Examples 	Check out Dublin's open data portal including extensive metadata

What	Defined by a Help or 'Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)' feature available on the portal. This feature is intended to help the user navigate the site and finding information and/or providing the user with an extensive knowledge base of commonly asked questions that users pose in their search for information.
Why	Provides instant, accurate, and accessible information, enhancing user experience, and promoting efficient communication between the government and people.
How?	Indicative steps: Identify Common Queries: - Analyze frequently asked questions and common issues people encounter while using the portal. User-Friendly Interface: - Design a clean and intuitive interface with a dedicated section for FAQs. Search Functionality: - Implement a robust search bar allowing users to enter keywords and find relevant FAQs quickly. Regular Updates: - Keep the FAQs updated based on new queries and changing policies. Remove outdated information. Prominent Placement: - Feature the FAQs prominently on the portal, making it easily accessible from the homepage and main navigation menu. For more information check out WebFx's guide on Help Features or Zendesk's guide for FAQs.
Case Examples	Check out Guayaquil's FAQs section (in Spanish).





7. Information on online services use (#241)

What	Defined by evidence that the portal offers guidance or tutorials to people in understanding and using online services, e.g. Help-Link. These can also come under the form of training manuals and/or tutorials aimed at helping users to better understand how to access and use online services.
Why	Empowers people by providing clear instructions, fostering digital literacy, and ensuring that all residents can confidently access and utilize online services effectively.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Assess User Needs: a. Identify common challenges users face while navigating the municipal website. 2. Develop Clear Content: a. Create easy-to-understand tutorials 3. Implement Help-Link Section: a. Integrate a dedicated Help section on the website. 4. Regular Updates: a. Keep the content up-to-date, and review tutorials with changing services, common user queries. 5. Multimedia Support: a. Enhance tutorials with multimedia elements like videos and infographics. 6. Regular Analytics Review: a. Analyze user engagement data. Identify popular topics and areas where users struggle. For more inspiration, check out the UAE's tutorial for e-services.
Case Examples	Check out Helsinki's digital support page.



8. Portal authentication (#245)

What	Also referred to as "e-ID" in some countries, it can be used through secure login methods, such as usernames, passwords, or multi-factor authentication to offer personalized online/mobile services to the user. Portal authentication ensures that the user's identity has to be verified when getting online.
Why	It ensures that individuals interacting with the portal are genuine and authorized, safeguards sensitive government data and services, enhancing online security and user trust.
How?	Indicative Steps 1. Identify Security Needs: - Determine the level of security required for the website 2. Choose Authentication Methods: - Select appropriate authentication methods, such as username/password, biometrics, or multi-factor authentication (MFA). 3. Develop User Database: - Create a secure database to store user credentials. 4. Integrate Authentication System: - Integrate the chosen authentication methods into the website's login process 5. Regular Security Audits: - Conduct regular security audits and updates to identify and address potential vulnerabilities Check out UK's National Cyber Security Center Guide or OWASP's Authentication Cheat Sheet
Case Examples 	Check out Digital Dubai Single Sign On Page Submit your case here



9. Live chat support with a person (#270a)

What	The provision of "live chat" support functionality with municipality employees/officers in real time . This covers real-time interaction through a person via different channels "click to chat", webchat, WeChat, WhatsApp, text messaging, and other live support functions.
Why	Provides real-time assistance, enhances people's engagement, and fosters transparent communication between residents and municipality employees/officers, improving overall public service accessibility and satisfaction.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Choose a Suitable Platform: a. Select a reliable live chat software that supports various channels (i.e. "click to chat," webchat, WeChat, WhatsApp, and text messaging. 2. Employee Training for handling real-time interactions effectively and professionally. 3. Integration: a. Seamlessly integrate the chosen live chat software into the municipal website. 4. User-Friendly Design: a. Design an intuitive interface with clickable icons or buttons, making it easy for users to initiate chats. 5. Monitoring and Improvement: a. Implement a monitoring system to track response times, review chat transcripts, and gather user feedback. Use this data to continuously enhance service quality and employee training. Check out dacast's guide or touchpoint
Case Examples 	Check out Dubai's link to a Whatsapp group

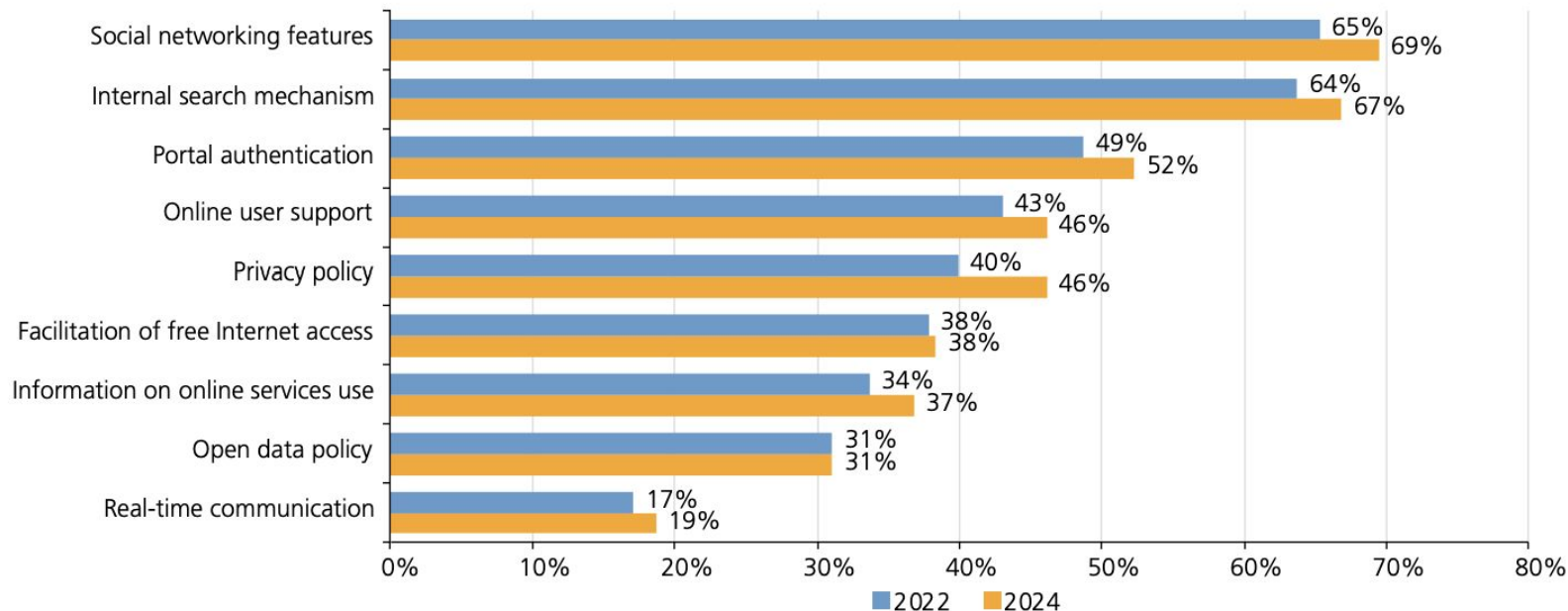


10. Social networking features (#273)

What	The provision of social networking feature(s) (e.g. Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Flickr, etc.) on the portal.
Why	Fosters direct and interactive communication with people, enhances transparency, and encourages community engagement, creating a dynamic platform for sharing information and gathering public input.
How?	Indicative steps: 1. Develop a Social Media Policy: a. Create clear guidelines for the use of social networking platforms. Define the purpose, responsible personnel, content guidelines, and response protocols. 2. Integrate Platforms Seamlessly: a. Work with web developers to seamlessly integrate social media buttons and feeds into your website. 3. Create Engaging Content: a. Develop a content strategy, share updates about local events, public services, policies, achievements. 4. Regular Updates and Maintenance: a. Ensure regular updates on social media platforms to keep people informed. 5. Promote Civic Initiatives: a. Utilize social media to promote civic initiatives, community events, and public awareness campaigns. 6. Monitor and Analyze: a. Utilize analytics tools provided by social media platforms to assess engagement, reach, and impact. Check out Sprout social's guide or Verbit's
Case Examples 	Check out Casablanca's social media accounts , appearing on all pages



Implementation of e-government literacy indicators in city portals (percentage of cities)



Source: UN E-Government Survey 2024, UN DESA

These numbers are represented by the 151 cities assessed for the 2024 LOSI